Atlanta Botanical Garden - Expansion

Manchurian Maple

Acer mandshuricum

Family: Not stated Also known as: —

GARDENS Overlook: 2 Wonderland: 1 **TOTAL 3**



Summer / form
Library candidate



Fall color
Library candidate

Not available

Flower
Not available



Leaf close-up
Library candidate

QUICK FACTS & PLANTING

Type: Tree
Evergreen/Deciduous: Deciduous
Mature size: 20–40 ft in cultivation (native habitat up to 90–100 ft). Confirmed range by multiple sources (RHS, Cornell, plant lust, Wikipedia). × 15–30 ft (sources range 8–15 ft to 30–40 ft). **Open:** Spread range varies; no tight three-source agreement.
Hardiness / Zone 8a: Suitable for Zone 8a. Hardy Zones 4–8/9 (sources vary). Performs in southern conditions with adequate moisture. Not stated for specific Atlanta notes beyond general hardiness. Restart pass (2026-10-13): Cornell Woody Plants lists 20–30 ft, Zone 4b, rose-red fall color earlier than other maples, insect and disease free. No Zone 8a-specific note. [https://woodyplants.cals.cornell.edu/plant/348]
Sun: Full sun to part shade.
Water: Medium. Prefers consistently moist, well-drained soil. Drought tolerant once established.
Soil: Well-drained, adaptable (clay, loam, sand). Acid to neutral preferred.
Growth rate: Not stated
Not stated
Planting:
Siting: Plant in full sun to part shade in moist, well-drained soil. Water regularly until established. Minimal pruning. Suitable as specimen or small shade tree.
Soil prep: Well-drained, adaptable (clay, loam, sand). Acid to neutral preferred.
Depth/spacing: Not stated
Season: Not stated
Establishment: Not stated

ORIGIN, CHARACTERISTICS & HEALTH

Origin / native: Native to Manchuria region (China, Korea, Russia). Introduced to Western cultivation in 1904 (Kew).
Form / habit: Deciduous tree. Slender, upright to spreading or vase-shaped. Trifoliate leaves.
Foliage: Rich red, orange, pink. Early and reliable.
Flowers / fruit: Not stated
Bark / stem: Smooth gray. Does not exfoliate (unlike related trifoliate maples).
Not stated
Health:
Health notes: Generally insect and disease free according to sources. No serious problems stated. **Open:** Specific Zone 8a data is thin.
Not stated
Additional:
- Trifoliate leaves (three leaflets). - Spectacular early fall color. - Relatively rare in cultivation. - Narrow habit suitable for smaller spaces.